

NorthBridge Analytics Inc.

Information Security Policy

Effective March 1, 2026 | Version 2.3
Information Technology & Security Department

This is a fictitious document generated for software testing purposes (hybrid search RAG and citation verification experiments). NorthBridge Analytics Inc. is not a real company and none of the policies, figures, or names below describe real persons or entities. This policy is designed to align with, and expand upon, Section 9 (Information Technology and Data Security) of the NorthBridge Employee Handbook, Version 4.2.

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1. Purpose and Scope

This Information Security Policy ("Policy") establishes the requirements for protecting the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information assets owned, processed, or managed by NorthBridge Analytics Inc. ("NorthBridge," "the Company"). It supplements and expands upon Section 9 (Information Technology and Data Security) of the NorthBridge Employee Handbook, Version 4.2, effective January 1, 2026.

This Policy applies to all full-time, part-time, and temporary employees, as well as contractors, interns, and any third party granted access to NorthBridge systems or data, across all four Company offices: Portland (headquarters), Austin, Toronto, and Kraków. NorthBridge is headquartered at 480 Cascade Avenue, Suite 700, Portland, Oregon, and as of the effective date of this Policy employs approximately 612 people company-wide.

2. Roles and Responsibilities

Section 2.1 — Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)

The CISO owns this Policy, sets the Company's overall security strategy, and reports quarterly to the Executive Leadership Team on the Company's security posture.

Section 2.2 — IT Security Team

The IT Security team administers technical controls, monitors for suspicious activity, investigates reported incidents, and maintains the security awareness training program described in Section 10.

Section 2.3 — Employees

All employees are responsible for complying with this Policy, completing required training, and promptly reporting any suspected security incident in accordance with Section 8.

3. Data Classification

Consistent with Section 9.3 of the Employee Handbook, all Company and client data is classified into one of three tiers. Handling requirements for each tier are detailed below.

Tier	Definition	Handling Requirement
Public	Information approved for unrestricted external release	No special handling required
Internal	Information intended for use within NorthBridge only	May not be shared outside the Company without manager approval
Restricted	Client PII, financial records, credentials, and other highly sensitive data	Must be encrypted at rest and in transit; may not be stored on personal devices

4. Access Control and Authentication

Section 4.1 — Multi-Factor Authentication

All employees must use multi-factor authentication (MFA) on all Company systems, consistent with Section 9.2 of the Employee Handbook.

Section 4.2 — Password Requirements

Passwords must be rotated at least every 180 days and must be a minimum of 12 characters, combining upper- and lower-case letters, numbers, and at least one special character. Shared accounts and shared credentials are strictly prohibited.

Section 4.3 — Least Privilege and Access Reviews

System access is granted on a least-privilege, role-based basis. Access to Restricted data must be approved by a manager and IT Security, and all access grants are reviewed on a quarterly basis. Access is revoked no later than the employee's last day of employment, consistent with Section 11.4 of the Employee Handbook (Return of Property).

5. Acceptable Use of Company Systems

Company-issued computing equipment, email, and network access are provided for business purposes. Limited personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with job performance or violate this Policy or the Employee Handbook. Employees may not install unauthorized software, disable endpoint security agents, or use Company systems to access, store, or transmit unlawful content.

6. Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

Employees who wish to access Company email or other Company data on a personal mobile device must enroll the device in the Company's mobile device management (MDM) platform, which enforces passcode requirements, encryption, and a remote-wipe capability for lost or stolen devices, consistent with Section 9.5 of the Employee Handbook. Enrollment must be completed within 5 business days of first accessing Company data on the device.

7. Physical and Environmental Security

All visitors to NorthBridge offices must sign in at the front desk and be escorted by a NorthBridge employee at all times, consistent with Section 8.3 of the Employee Handbook. Server rooms and network closets require badge access limited to authorized IT Security personnel. Employees must lock their workstation screens whenever leaving their desk unattended.

8. Incident Response

Section 8.1 — Reporting

Any suspected security incident, including phishing attempts, malware infections, unauthorized access, or lost or stolen devices, must be reported to the IT Security team at security@northbridge-analytics.example within 2 hours of discovery, consistent with Section 9.4 of the Employee Handbook. Incidents may also be reported through the confidential NorthBridge Ethics Hotline at 1-800-555-0134.

Section 8.2 — Response Timeline

Severity	Definition	Initial Response Target
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Critical	Active breach of Restricted data or system-wide outage	Within 1 hour
High	Confirmed malware or unauthorized access to Internal Systems	Within 4 hours
Medium	Suspected phishing or policy violation with limited scope	Within 1 business day
Low	Isolated, low-risk event (e.g., a single misdirected email)	Within 3 business days

Section 8.3 — Post-Incident Review

Following resolution of any Critical or High severity incident, IT Security will conduct a post-incident review within 10 business days and share findings with affected department leads.

9. Third-Party and Vendor Security

Vendors and contractors granted access to NorthBridge systems or Restricted data must sign a data processing agreement and complete a security questionnaire prior to onboarding. Vendor access is reviewed annually and revoked immediately upon contract termination.

10. Security Awareness Training

All new employees must complete security awareness training within their first 30 days of employment, aligning with the 90-calendar-day introductory period described in Section 2.1 of the Employee Handbook. All employees must complete annual refresher training, and repeated failure to complete required training may be addressed under the Company's progressive discipline model described in Section 10.4 of the Employee Handbook.

11. Policy Exceptions and Enforcement

Any exception to this Policy must be requested in writing to the CISO and is granted only for a defined period with compensating controls. Violations of this Policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, consistent with the Employee Handbook's progressive discipline model.

12. Policy Review and Acknowledgment

This Policy is reviewed annually by the IT Security team and CISO, and more frequently if required by changes in law, technology, or Company risk posture. By signing below, I acknowledge that I have received and reviewed the NorthBridge Analytics Inc. Information Security Policy, Version 2.3, effective March 1, 2026, and I understand that non-compliance may result in disciplinary action.

Employee Name: _____

Employee Signature: _____

Date: _____

This document contains fictitious dummy content generated for testing a hybrid search RAG pipeline with citation verification. Section numbers and specific figures throughout this policy are intended to support retrieval-accuracy and citation-grounding evaluation, including cross-document consistency checks against the NorthBridge Employee Handbook.